

Domain, e-mail and hosting guide

For the administrator - free hosting, e-mail forwarding, contact form, private code

Goal: the website at www.memoria-judaica.de, the four addresses [info@](mailto:info@memoria-judaica.de), [mueller@](mailto:mueller@memoria-judaica.de), [huettenmeister@](mailto:huettenmeister@memoria-judaica.de) and [bondy@](mailto:bondy@memoria-judaica.de) forwarded to the Memoria Gmail inbox, and the website contact form delivered to the same inbox. Hosting, DNS and mail forwarding are free. The only cost is the domain name itself (a yearly fee at a registrar).

Confirm the Gmail address first: it is memoriajudaica@gmail.com in all files. memoria-judaica@gmail.com cannot exist, because Gmail addresses cannot contain a hyphen. If the real address is different, change it in Cloudflare (Step 3) and in Code.gs (CONTACT_TO, Step 6).

The big picture

What	Where	Cost
Website (the built pages)	GitHub Pages (public code) or Cloudflare Pages (private code)	free
Name servers and DNS	Cloudflare (free plan)	free
Receiving mail for the 4 addresses	Cloudflare Email Routing, forwarded to Gmail	free
Website contact form	Google Apps Script in your sheet, mails to Gmail	free
Domain name memoria-judaica.de	Any registrar that lets you change name servers	yearly fee

Step 1 - Register the domain

1. Check at a registrar that memoria-judaica.de is free and buy it. Choose a registrar that lets you change the name servers (all common ones do). Switch on the registrar's two-factor login and keep the invoice.
2. Use the Memoria Gmail address as the owner / contact e-mail, so reminders reach the inbox the team reads.
3. Optional: memoria-judaica.com and memoria-judaica.org protect against look-alike addresses and typos. They are extra yearly fees and only forward to the .de site. The site works without them. Availability has not been checked.

Step 2 - Move the DNS to Cloudflare (free)

1. Sign up at cloudflare.com with the Memoria Gmail address and switch on two-factor login.
2. Click Add a domain, enter memoria-judaica.de and choose the Free plan. Let Cloudflare scan existing records.
3. Cloudflare shows two name servers. Log in at your registrar and replace the current name servers with these two. Wait until Cloudflare shows the domain as Active (minutes to 24 hours).

Step 3 - Forward the four e-mail addresses to Gmail

1. In Cloudflare open your domain > Email > Email Routing > Get started.
2. Under Destination addresses add the Gmail address. Cloudflare sends a confirmation e-mail to that inbox: open it and click the link.
3. Under Routing rules > Custom addresses create these four rules, each with action "Send to an email" and the Gmail address as destination:

Address	Forwards to
info@memoria-judaica.de	memoriajudaica@gmail.com
mueller@memoria-judaica.de	memoriajudaica@gmail.com
huettenmeister@memoria-judaica.de	memoriajudaica@gmail.com
bondy@memoria-judaica.de	memoriajudaica@gmail.com

4. When Cloudflare offers to add the MX and SPF records, accept ("Add records and enable"). Do not delete these records later.
5. Optional: set the Catch-all address to forward to Gmail as well, so mistyped addresses are not lost (it also attracts more spam).
6. Test: from another mail account send a message to each of the four addresses. Check the Gmail inbox and the spam folder. If one lands in spam, open it and click "Not spam".

Step 4 - Reply from info@ (optional)

Forwarding only receives mail. Replying from Gmail shows the Gmail address unless you add a "Send mail as" address:

1. Gmail > Settings (gear) > See all settings > Accounts and Import > Send mail as > Add another email address. Enter the name and info@memoria-judaica.de.
2. SMTP server: smtp.gmail.com, port 587, secure connection (TLS). Username: the Gmail address. Password: a Google **app password** (Google Account > Security > 2-Step Verification must be on > App passwords).
3. Gmail sends a confirmation message to info@ - it arrives through the forwarding. Click the link. Repeat for the other three addresses if you want.
4. In Cloudflare DNS edit the existing SPF TXT record so that it also contains Google. Keep what is already there, for example: **v=spf1 include:_spf.mx.cloudflare.net include:_spf.google.com ~all**. Only ONE SPF record may exist.

Limit of this free setup: there are no separate mailboxes. All four addresses end up in one inbox; use Gmail filters or labels (To: bondy@...) to sort them.

Step 5 - Connect the website to the domain (GitHub Pages route)

1. GitHub: repository memoria-judaica > Settings > Pages > Custom domain: enter **www.memoria-judaica.de** and Save. (Do this before the DNS step.)
2. Cloudflare > DNS > Records. Add a CNAME record: name **www**, target **YOUR-USERNAME.github.io** (no repository name), Proxy status **DNS only** (grey cloud).
3. So that memoria-judaica.de (without www) also works, add four A records for name **@** with these IP addresses, Proxy status DNS only: 185.199.108.153, 185.199.109.153, 185.199.110.153, 185.199.111.153. GitHub then redirects to www.

4. Back in GitHub Settings > Pages wait until the DNS check is green, then tick **Enforce HTTPS** (the certificate can take up to a day).
5. In your content sheet, tab Texts: set emailAddress = info@memoria-judaica.de and websiteAddress = www.memoria-judaica.de, then publish. The Impressum picks the e-mail up automatically.

Step 6 - Contact form to the Gmail inbox

Code.gs in the package contains the contact-form receiver. The form sends its data to the same web-app link that already delivers the website content (Admin guide, Steps 5 to 7).

1. Open the sheet > Extensions > Apps Script and paste the whole Code.gs from the package. Put your GitHub user name in the first lines and check CONTACT_TO. Save.
2. Deploy > Manage deployments > pencil icon > Version: **New version** > Deploy. (The link stays the same.)
3. Reload the sheet and click Website > **Send a test contact e-mail**. Allow the new permission (Advanced > Go to project (unsafe) > Allow, "send email as you"). The test message arrives in the Gmail inbox.
4. Click Website > Publish website now, wait 3 minutes, open the live website > Kontakt and send a message with your own e-mail address. It should arrive in Gmail within a minute with the visitor's address as reply address.

Spam protection: a hidden field that only robots fill in, a minimum time of 3 seconds before sending, and at most 20 messages per hour. Messages are not stored on the website. If sending fails, the visitor sees a message asking to write to the e-mail address directly.

Datenschutz: the page must name the services involved: the hosting provider (GitHub Pages or Cloudflare Pages), Cloudflare (DNS, mail forwarding) and Google (the script that sends the form data, and the Gmail inbox). Please complete the Datenschutz text in the tab Legal pages and have it checked by a professional before going public.

Step 7 - Keeping the website code private (optional)

The website itself is always public: anyone can use "View source" to see the packed code and the texts. A private repository only hides the original files (build setup, script, structure). The contact link and the website texts are public anyway.

- **GitHub Free:** private repositories are free, but GitHub Pages from a private repository needs a paid plan (GitHub Pro or higher). If a free account switches the repository to private, the live site shows a 404 error.
- **Free and private - Cloudflare Pages:** the repository stays private. The GitHub build robot builds the site and uploads it to Cloudflare Pages. Cloudflare already holds the domain and the mail forwarding, so it fits well. GitHub gives a free account a monthly quota of build minutes for private repositories (enough for occasional publishing, not unlimited).
- **Paid:** GitHub Pro with a private repository and GitHub Pages (the site is still public).
- **Public repository:** free and simple; acceptable if no passwords are stored in it. Anyone can copy the design.

Steps for the Cloudflare route (the file docs/deploy-cloudflare.yml.txt was written for this; it has not been tested here):

1. In Cloudflare: Workers and Pages > Create > Pages > Direct Upload. Project name: memoria-judaica. Upload any small file once to create it.
2. Cloudflare > My Profile > API Tokens > Create token > template "Edit Cloudflare Workers" (or a token with Cloudflare Pages: Edit). Copy the token. Copy your Account ID from the Cloudflare dashboard.
3. GitHub repository > Settings > Secrets and variables > Actions > New repository secret: CLOUDFLARE_API_TOKEN and CLOUDFLARE_ACCOUNT_ID.
4. Replace the content of .github/workflows/deploy.yml with the content of docs/deploy-cloudflare.yml.txt (same file name, so the Publish button in the sheet keeps working). Run the workflow once and open the project's pages.dev address.
5. In the Cloudflare Pages project > Custom domains: add www.memoria-judaica.de. Cloudflare creates the DNS record itself because the DNS is already there.
6. Only when the site loads from Cloudflare: GitHub > repository > Settings > General > Danger Zone > Change visibility > Make private. Do not do this earlier.

Never store passwords or tokens inside the repository: the GitHub token lives in the sheet script settings (Script properties) and the Cloudflare token in the GitHub secrets.

Checklist

- Domain bought, owner e-mail = Memoria Gmail, two-factor on at registrar, GitHub, Cloudflare and Google.
- Cloudflare domain Active; Email Routing: destination verified, 4 rules, MX/SPF added; test mails received.
- Website connected to the domain (GitHub Pages or Cloudflare Pages), HTTPS on.
- New Code.gs deployed as a new version; test e-mail received; contact form tested on the live site.
- Texts tab: emailAddress and websiteAddress updated; Datenschutz completed.

If something does not work

- **Site shows only the github.io or pages.dev address:** check the DNS records (grey cloud for GitHub Pages). Wait up to 24 hours.
- **"Enforce HTTPS" not selectable:** wait; GitHub issues the certificate after the DNS check.
- **Mail does not arrive:** check the spam folder; in Cloudflare Email Routing see that the destination shows Verified and that the MX records still exist.
- **Form message does not arrive:** run Website > Send a test contact e-mail; if that works, publish again and check that the web-app deployment is "Anyone" and the newest version.
- Free-plan limits and prices change over time; check each provider's current terms when you sign up.